

Estimating prevalence of overweight and obesity in Honduras, using DHS data

Álvaro Quijano Angarita

Introduction

The current report pertains to one of the projects in the UNC Latin American Health Studies (UNC LHS), a personal initiative that involves using readily available data from Latin American countries, processing the datasets, deriving variables of interest, and addressing specific research questions. In this case, the project corresponds to LHS0003, and its objective is to estimate the probability of overweight and obesity in Honduras using Demographic and Health Survey (DHS) data and to map these estimates in a spatial format.

Data and Methods

Data

The probability of overweight and obesity among women aged 12 to 49 years in Honduras was estimated using data from the Honduran Demographic and Health Survey (DHS, ENDESA in spanish) with a complex survey design.

The Encuesta Nacional de Demografía y Salud (ENDESA) 2019 is a comprehensive survey conducted in Honduras to provide updated information on key indicators related to health, education, and population trends. This initiative, led by the National Institute of Statistics (INE) and the Secretariat of Health (SESAL), also tracks progress toward the Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) and national plans. ENDESA covers diverse topics, including maternal and child health, reproductive health, nutritional trends, early childhood development, and domestic violence. The survey includes data collection through household and individual questionnaires for women, men, and children, alongside measures like anemia tests and water quality assessments. For this analysis, we used data exclusively from the women’s questionnaire, focusing on women aged 15–49. This allows us to examine health, reproductive, and social indicators specific to this population.

The full survey and details can be accessed at:
<https://ine.gob.hn/v4/endesa/>

Methods

The data was modeled using the *survey* package in R, that accounts for the multi-stage sampling design, specifically the primary sampling units (PSUs), stratification variable, and survey weights to ensure nationally representative estimates. To estimate probability rates, a logistic regression model with a logit link function was fitted using the *svyglm* function, which is specifically designed for complex survey data. This approach incorporate the survey design in the estimates and provides robust variance estimates. The response variable was overweight/obesity, modeled as a function of predictors such as women’s age categories, wealth, education level, wealth index and others. This method leverages the flexibility of generalized linear models while appropriately handling the complexities of survey sampling, ensuring accurate and reliable prevalence estimates that account for the design’s stratification, clustering, and weighting.

Project structure

For estimating the

- LHS000301: Read the raw data and derived the needed variables in the project
- LHS000302: Creates a report that shows the number of missing data per variable
- LHS000303: Generate the univariate prevalences of overweight and obesity
- LHS000304:

Results

Estimating the univariate prevalences of overweight and obesity

Variable	Level	Prevalence
Region	Atlantida	0.6857
Region	Colon	0.6374
Region	Comayagua	0.6215
Region	Copan	0.5284
Region	Cortes	0.6428
Region	Choluteca	0.6354
Region	El Paraiso	0.5702
Region	Francisco Morazan	0.6379
Region	Gracias A Dios	0.7285
Region	Intibuca	0.5167
Region	Islas De La Bahia	0.7145
Region	La Paz	0.5535
Region	Lempira	0.4022
Region	Ocotepeque	0.5474
Region	Olancho	0.6250
Region	Santa Barbara	0.5808
Region	Valle	0.6737
Region	Yoro	0.6372
Region	San Pedro Sula	0.6471
Region	Distrito Central	0.6770

Variable	Level	Prevalence
Women's Age	[15,20)	0.2710
Women's Age	[20,30)	0.5555
Women's Age	[30,40)	0.7670
Women's Age	[40,50]	0.8240

Variable	Level	Prevalence
Wealth status	Poorest	0.5041
Wealth status	Poorer	0.5990
Wealth status	Middle	0.6467
Wealth status	Richer	0.6602
Wealth status	Richest	0.6504

Variable	Level	Prevalence
Area	Rural	0.5845
Area	Urban	0.6538

Variable	Level	Prevalence
Education	No education/Primary	0.6703
Education	Secondary/Highschool	0.5531
Education	Higher education	0.6314

Figure 1: Prevalence of age categories in the study.

The prevalence of overweight and obesity among women aged 12 to 49 in Honduras reveals significant disparities across regions, age groups, wealth status, areas of residence, and education levels. The highest prevalence is observed in the regions of Gracias A Dios (72.85%) and Islas De La Bahia (71.45%), while the lowest is in Lempira (40.22%), reflecting substantial regional variation. Overweight and obesity rates increase consistently with age, from 27.10% in women aged 15-20 to 82.40% in those aged 40-50. Urban areas (65.38%) show higher prevalence compared to rural areas (58.45%), likely due to differences in lifestyle and dietary patterns. Wealthier groups have higher prevalence rates, peaking at 66.02% among richer individuals, though the trend stabilizes among the richest. Women with no or primary education (67.03%) are most affected, while those with secondary or high school education show a lower prevalence (55.31%). These findings highlight the need for targeted interventions, particularly among younger women, rural populations, and those with lower education levels, to address the growing public health concern of obesity and overweight in Honduras.

Overwieght maps

Probability of Women Overweight and Obesity in Honduras by Wealth Status, 2019

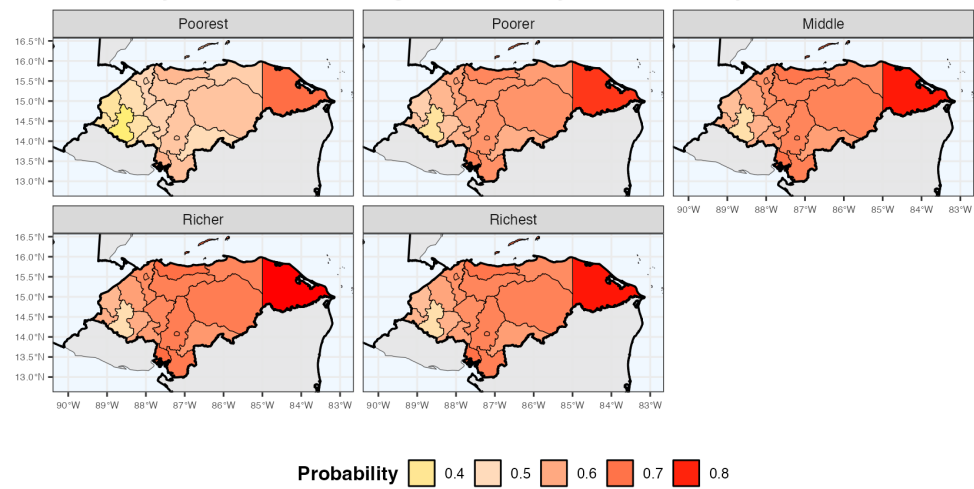


Figure 2: Map of probabilities

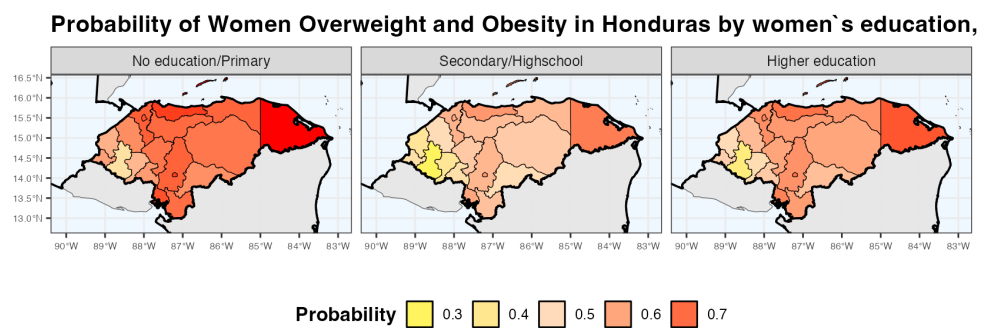


Figure 3: Map of probabilities

Probability of Women Overweight and Obesity in Honduras by women`s age, 2019

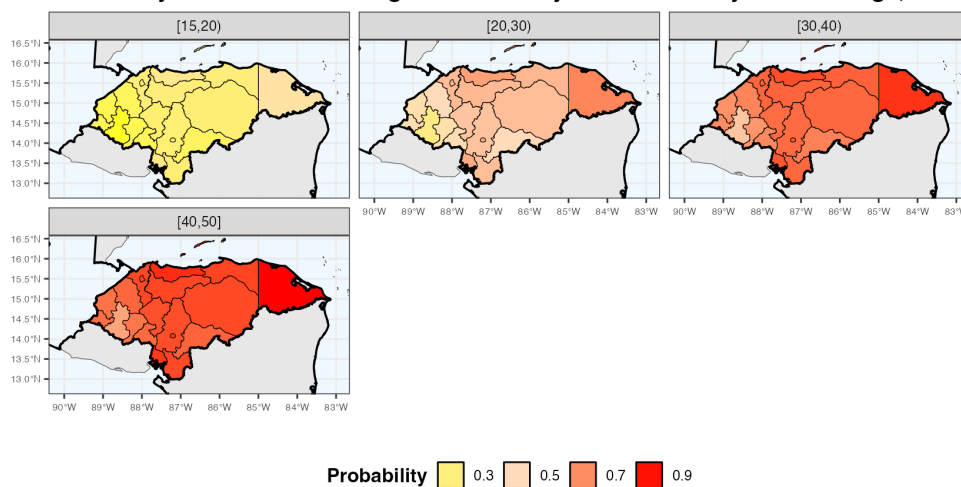


Figure 4: Map of probabilities

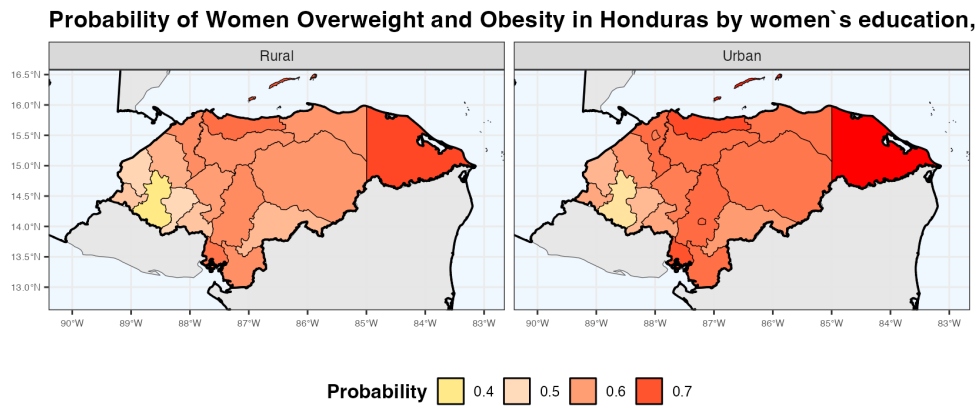


Figure 5: Map of probabilities